

Ian Cowpar

PM building at principal scope | AI-fluent prototyping | data products with opinion | zero-translation systems

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SUMMARY

Senior Product Manager operating at principal scope, building AI tooling, data products, and 0→1 systems — and shipping them fast. I write the working prototype, not just the spec — I built the 0→1 migration tool's prototype myself in Claude Code, idea to engineering-ready in one week, and it's in production today. Two years at UKG protecting 300 enterprise customers (\$250M ARR) through a multi-year migration: owned product strategy and roadmap, set success metrics, drove cross-functional delivery, and scaled the org's first organized AI capability layer with no top-down mandate. UKG is an HCM platform — exactly the kind of workforce system embedded financial services reach frontline workers through. A decade prior at Broadridge: 40+ enterprise deployments in compliance-grade financial services.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager Jun 2024 – Apr 2026

UKG | Lowell, MA | \$250M ARR | AI tooling, data products, and 0→1 builds protecting enterprise customers through migration

- **Built a 0→1 self-serve migration tool — idea to engineering-ready in one week.** Took it from concept through three business-epic decomposition (UI, rules, deployment), wrote the working prototype myself in Claude Code, designed the UX feedback loop and persona, and handed engineering a complete delivery package — bepsics, epics, stories, Gantt, roadmap. In production with the first customer cohort — 6 enterprise accounts in flight, Services running migrations without an engineering ticket. Built and shipped, not just spec'd.
- **Built UKG product's first organized AI capability layer.** Started as a personal automation library; built it into a shared repo 20 PMs could pull from, ran the first peer group, and sat with two PMs directly to configure it for their own use cases. Designed from the start to spread without a mandate — shared infrastructure, not personal tooling, because the only adoption that lasts is the kind nobody had to order.
- **Designed a five-panel operational analytics product** classifying open issues across customer escalations, code defects, internal bugs, CVEs, and noise across four products; auto-refreshed daily, with a Claude Code function I built into the tool surfacing the single highest-leverage action per panel. Cut the working defect list ~97% — roughly 200 apparent issues resolved to a real five — so engineering triaged signal, not noise. Opinionated routing, not a dashboard.
- **Built an ARR-risk model for the upgrade program** scoring the top 10 accounts on a blend of ARR exposure, reported-case volume, true-defect count, and Salesforce sentiment — not raw ticket counts. Defined the success metric, automated weekly reporting, and routed every open blocker to the program lead; live tracking surfaced aging issues before they escalated.
- **Served as the product-side voice on enterprise customer escalation and pre-upgrade calls** — synthesizing what 300 customers (\$250M ARR) actually needed versus what was on the roadmap, turning behavior and qualitative signal into prioritization and tradeoff decisions across product, engineering, and GTM.
- **Designed sprint health instrumentation** refreshing every 15 minutes across two engineering teams, with documented rejection criteria for burndown, velocity, and story-point anti-patterns — each with technical rationale. Built for signal, not ceremony.

Brand Champion, UKG North America Regional Lead 2026 | Fire Up ERG (women and allies), Business Innovation workstream lead

Business Analyst Jan 2014 – Jun 2024

Broadridge Financial Solutions | Andover, MA

- Led 40+ enterprise client deployments end-to-end in a compliance-grade financial services environment; partnered deeply with engineering on system behavior, data flows, and technical tradeoffs, and built strong instincts for turning messy customer input into clear, buildable requirements.
- Internal SME for an omni-channel communication product adopted across the full client base; turned complex capabilities into experiences non-technical users could operate without support.

Sr. Document Development Analyst Jan 2006 – Jan 2014

Broadridge Financial Solutions | Andover, MA

SKILLS AND FOCUS AREAS

AI as Co-Builder: Deep working fluency with current AI tools, Claude Code prototyping, agentic workflows, AI-fluent product development, technical-systems fluency (APIs, data models, integration tradeoffs), PM automation, zero-translation building

Data & Analytics: Data products with opinion, hypothesis design and success-metric definition, composite scoring and risk modeling, experiment-adjacent measurement design, opinionated instrumentation, qualitative-to-structured synthesis, data-driven decisioning

Product: 0→1 product building and iteration, product strategy and roadmap, prioritization and tradeoff decisions in ambiguous spaces, discovery-through-launch ownership, end-to-end delivery from prototype to production, cross-functional influence, B2B SaaS

Fintech & Enterprise: Compliance-grade financial services, HCM / workforce-platform environment, embedded-services distribution context, regulatory-consequence delivery, executive customer engagement, escalation-room presence

Tooling: Jira, Confluence, GitHub, SQL, Slack MCP, Claude Code CLI

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Management Information Systems and Management

Manning School of Business, UMass Lowell | 1999

WRITING AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

The Unofficial Leader (Substack) | theunofficialleader.substack.com

Weekly publication on AI adoption, unofficial leadership, and what's happening beneath the surface of how teams work. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework. Active LinkedIn audience engagement on product, AI adoption, and team dynamics.